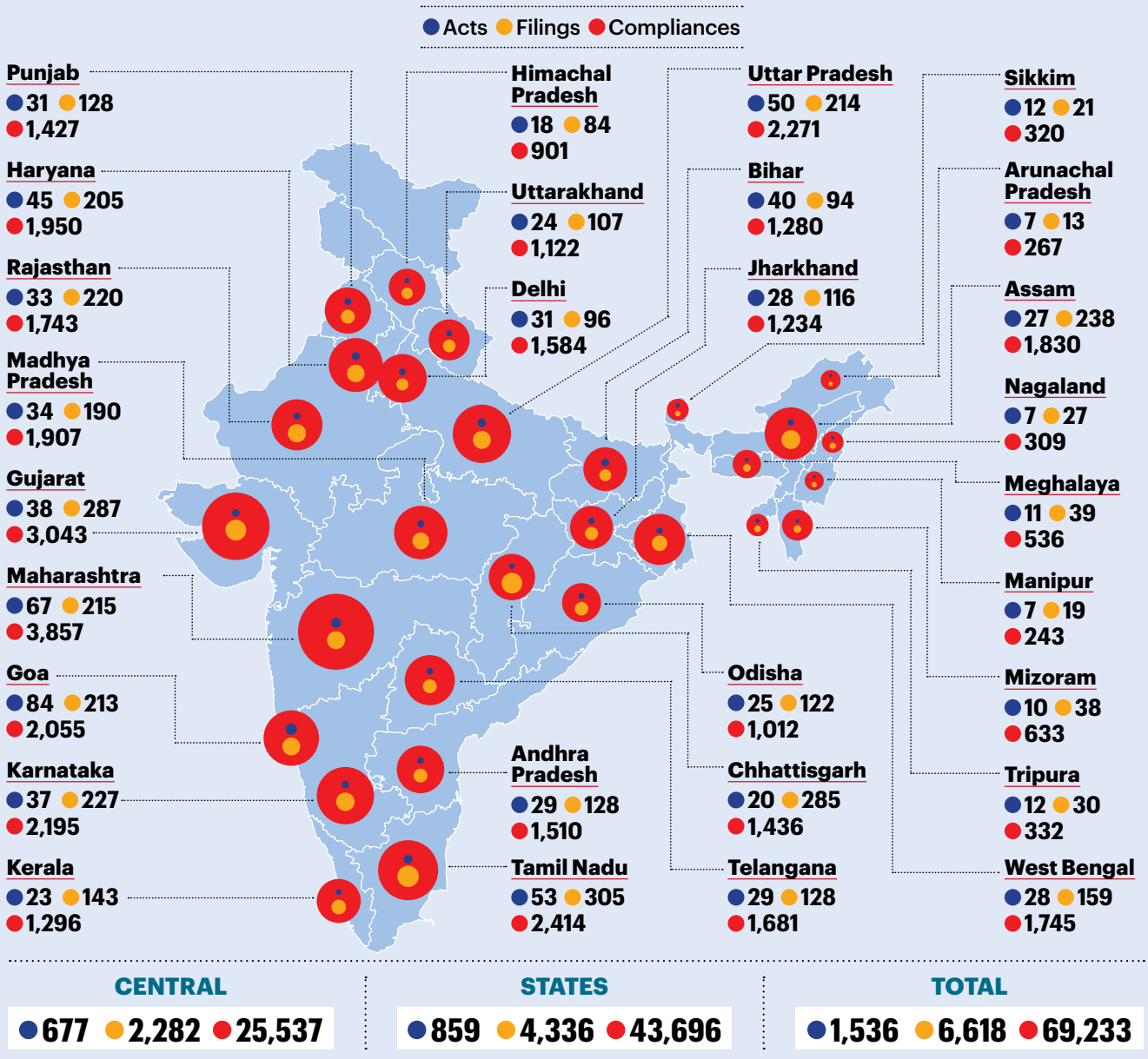
THE MULTIPLICITY MAYHEM

Businesses in India are subject to 1,536 central and state legislations, making compliance tricky



Source: Teamlease RegTech

businesses from legacy constraints and put the economy on a superfast track to meet the new global context. Union finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman picked up the thread in the budget document a day later, announcing the formation of a high-level committee chaired by cabinet secretary T.V. Somanathan, and comprising officials from the NITI Aayog and the Prime Minister's Office. It was mandated to review all non-financial sector regulations, certifications, licences and permissions. A deregulation commission was mooted too, to work closely with compliance-heavy states. "The objective," Sitharaman said, "is to strengthen trust-based economic governance and take transformational measures to enhance 'ease of doing business', especially in matters of inspections and compliances. States will be encouraged to join this endeavour."

The Compliance Chokehold

From launch to liquidation, businesses in India, big and small, are caught in an exhausting labyrinth of regulations. According to a 2024 white paper by TeamLease RegTech, part of the staffing and human capital firm Teamlease Services, Indian enterprises are subject to a staggering 1,536 different acts, requiring 69,233 compliances and 6,618 annual filings. These regulations operate at multiple tiers—central, state, municipal and panchayat—and often overlap. This is because land is a subject under the state

Graphics by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY